GARDEN CITY CHURCH

LIVE THE LIFE. TELL THE STORY.

SECURITY MINISTRY MANUAL



PREPARED. PRAYERFUL.
PROTECTING HIS PEOPLE.

MINISTRY OVERVIEW

PURPOSE

The Security Ministry exists to protect the flock, support the mission, and maintain a safe environment where people can encounter Jesus without fear or distraction.

MISSION

Create a watchful, trained, and spiritually grounded security presence that is both welcoming and protective.

CORE SCRIPTURE

“Be on guard; stand firm in the faith; be courageous; be strong.” — 1 Corinthians 16:13

TEAM STRUCTURE

SECURITY DIRECTOR

- Oversees team, scheduling, training, and documentation.

TEAM LEADER

- Manage Sunday operations, stations, radio communication, and incident response.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBERS

- Serve on rotation, secure zones, document incidents, and assist guests/pastors.

ONBOARDING PROCESS

(Required for all Security Team members)

INVITATION

- Extend a personal invitation to serve, emphasizing maturity, reliability, and spiritual readiness.

INTERVIEW

Review:

- Ministry purpose, roles, expectations
- Time commitment and rotation
- Discipleship requirement (Following Jesus)
- Provide a printed ministry manual (non-negotiable)

BACKGROUND CHECK

- Mandatory for all Security team members
- Must be completed before shadowing

CPR/FIRST AID TRAINING

- Highly recommended for all team members
- At least 50% certified by the end of the following year.

SAFETY & SECURITY TRAINING

Includes:

- Walkthrough protocol
- Emergency procedures
- Radio/walkie-talkie training
- Active shooter/violent intruder
- Evacuation routes
- Incident reporting
- Children's wing protocols

SECURITY TEAM FUNCTIONS AS A SPIRITUAL MINISTRY

- Completion of Following Jesus Required
- Consistent Sunday Worship attendance
- Spiritual health and accountability

SCHEDULING

Once all steps are completed, members are added to the rotating schedule via Planning Center.

WEEKLY SAFETY WALKTHROUGH PROTOCOL

Every Sunday (or event), the on-duty team conducts a **full facility sweep** before doors open.

EXTERIOR WALKTHROUGH

- Scan parking lot for suspicious vehicles or persons
- Confirm all exterior doors are locked except designated entrances
- Check lighting, pathways, and visibility

INTERIOR WALKTHROUGH

- Inspect sanctuary, hallways, classrooms, restrooms
- Ensure fire exits are unobstructed
- Confirm emergency equipment (AED, extinguishers) is accessible
- Verify children's wing check-in is secure
- Ensure no individuals are lingering in restricted areas

IDENTIFY ALL EXITS

Team members must know:

- Primary exits
- Secondary exits
- Emergency-only exits
- Handicap-accessible routes

EVACUATION MEETING POINT

Designated meeting locations outside the building:

- **Primary:** (Specify a clear outdoor landmark, e.g., “far corner of the parking lot near the large tree”)
- **Secondary:** (Alternate if primary is compromised)

The Security Team leads evacuation flow and ensures no one re-enters the building until cleared.

TRAINING REQUIREMENTS

CPR & FIRST AID

Team must know:

- How to recognize emergencies
- When to call 911
- Who is certified on duty
- AED location & basic use

ACTIVE SHOOTER/VIOLENT INTRUDER

Training covers:

- “Run, Hide, Fight” principles
- Lockdown vs. Evacuation
- Protecting the Children’s Wing
- Coordinating with Law Enforcement
- Communicating with the pastoral team

WALKIE-TALKIE/RADIO TRAINING

Every team member must know how to:

- Turn radios on/off
- Switch channels
- Adjust volume
- Use earpiece/mic
- Perform radio checks
- Speak clearly & calmly
- Keep radio chatter to mission-critical communication

RADIO CODE LANGUAGE

Code	Meaning
Code 1	Non-emergency assistance needed
Code 2	Suspicious person/behavior
Code 3	Medical emergency
Code 4	Situation resolved, all clear
Code 5	Escort needed (children’s or parking)
Code 6	Disturbance / disruptive behavior
Code 7	Missing child
Code 10	Lockdown procedure
Priority	Active threat – immediate action required

RADIO PROTOCOL BASICS

- Speak clearly.
- Keep messages short.
- Say who you're calling, then yourself:
- "Security Lead, this is Front Door."
- Confirm with: "Copy" or "Received."
- No side conversations over radio.

STATION RESPONSIBILITIES

MAIN ENTRANCE

- Greet warmly but stay alert
- Watch body language, bags, unusual behavior
- Monitor flow of guests

SANCTUARY

- Scan the room regularly
- Watch for medical or emotional distress
- Station yourself where visibility is highest

CHILDREN'S WING

- No unauthorized entry
- Ensure parents follow check-in protocol
- Support Kids Ministry Team during emergencies

PARKING LOT

- Monitor exterior activity
- Assist families and elderly
- Watch surroundings and street access points

DISCIPLESHIP LIFESTYLE

SECURITY TEAM MEMBERS MUST:

- Maintain personal devotion
- Attend worship, not just serve
- Walk in humility and peace
- Represent Jesus with strength and grace
- Practice self-control at all times
- Honor pastoral authority

INCIDENT REPORTING & OFFENSE MANUAL

WHEN TO FILE AN INCIDENT REPORT

- Medical emergency
- Confrontation or disturbance
- Suspicious person
- Injury
- Lost/missing child
- Safety concern
- Any police involvement
- Anything that “feels off”

INCIDENT REPORT MUST INCLUDE:

- Date & time
- Location
- Description of event
- Names of individuals involved
- Action taken
- Team members present
- Follow-up needed
- Whether police/EMS were contacted

OFFENSE MANUAL CATEGORIES

- **Minor Disturbances**
  - Loud talking, uncooperative guest, minor disagreement
- **Moderate Incidents**
  - Disruptive person, emotional episode, medical episodes
- **Major Incidents**
  - Threats, violence, injury, missing child, police involvement
- **Critical Incidents**
  - Active shooter, bomb threat, fire evacuation, lockdown

Each category has clear expectations for reporting, documentation, and pastoral notification.

EMERGENCY RESPONSE PROTOCOLS

MEDICAL EMERGENCY

- Call certified responder
- Notify Security Lead
- Clear immediate area
- Stay calm and keep crowd back
- Document incident

FIRE OR SMOKE

- Pull alarm if needed
- Begin evacuation
- Direct people to meeting point
- Do not allow re-entry

DISTURBANCE

- Approach calmly
- Ask to speak privately
- Notify Security Lead
- Escalate only if necessary

MISSING CHILD

- Lock exits
- Notify Pastoral Team & Kids Team immediately
- Sweep building in pairs
- Document everything

VIOLENT THREAT/ACTIVE SHOOTER

- Alert via radio using “PRIORITY”
- Direct people to “Run, Hide, Fight”
- Protect children’s wing
- Assist pastoral staff
- Call 911 immediately
- Guide evacuation when safe

SCHEDULING & ROTATION

- Rotating schedule via Planning Center
- Minimum: Serve 1–2 times monthly
- Arrive 45 minutes before service
- Confirm schedule weekly
- No unapproved no-shows
- Swap responsibly with another trained team member

CODE OF CONDUCT

Security Team members will:

- Maintain confidentiality
- Stay sober and alert
- Never carry weapons unless approved by Senior Pastor
- Never use force unless necessary to prevent harm
- Avoid unnecessary confrontation
- Maintain self-control and Christ-like character

Violation may result in temporary or permanent removal.

RESOURCES & CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

Recommended Training Sources

- Local Police Department training
- FEMA Active Shooter Preparedness
- Red Cross CPR/First Aid Certification
- Church Security Alliance resources
- MinistrySafe training
- Assemblies of God Safety & Security guidelines

ANNUAL REVIEW

- Full manual reviewed yearly
- New threats or needs addressed
- Retraining for entire team